also triggered a shadowy war in Tehran between Prime Minister Mohammad-Ali Rajai and President Seyyed Abolhassan Banisadr. R&AW analysts said:

The IRP and President Banisadr continued their effort to out-manoeuvre each other. In order to circumvent the President's prerogative of refusing to approve the candidates proposed by the Prime Minister for the three vacant ministries, the IRP controlled Majlis (Parliament) made a move to appoint supervisors for these ministries. In a letter addressed to the President, 120 MPs asserted the constitutional validity of their stand in this regard. President Banisadr was apparently driven to a situation in which he had to approve the appointment of Ardebelli as Minister of Finance and Hassan Nizami as Minister of Commerce on 12 March 1981. The next day, speaker Akbar Hashemi Rafsanjani managed to get a bill approved by the Majlis authorising the Prime Minister to head the vacant ministries. In the meantime, a great controversy arose over the identity of the persons responsible for creating disturbances in the President's public meeting in the Tehran University and the manner in which the troublemakers were dispersed. President Banisadr charged that some of the 200 persons, who had been arrested on this occasion, were not only armed but also connected with the special armed forces of the Prime Minister's office. While the Prime Minister denied the existence of such a force, the IRP blamed the President for creating disorder alleging that it had been stage-managed to challenge the Rajai government. Banisadr maintained that since police personnel were beaten up, he had to ask people to overpower the culprits. The IRP questioned the legal status of the President's bodyguards and the budget from which they were financed. It also alleged that those who intervened on behalf of the President were members of the leftists' armed bodies as well as